ZCAS UNIVERSITY

SCHOOL OF COMPUTING, TECHNOLOGY & APPLIED SCIENCES

CIT5251 - STRATEGIC IT PLANNING AND MANAGEMENT FINAL EXAMINATION

DATE: FRIDAY 30th MAY, 2025

TIME: 14:00 - 17:00 HOURS

TIME ALLOWED : WRITING – THREE HOURS

READING – 5 MINUTES

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Section A: This question is **compulsory** and must be attempted.
2. Sections B: Answer **TWO (2)** questions from this section.
3. This examination paper carries a total of **100 marks.**
4. Candidates must **not turn this page** until the invigilator tells them to do so.

SECTION A: Question 1 is compulsory and must be attempted

Case Study: Integrated Health Information System Implementation in Zambia

The Ministry of Health in Zambia is planning to implement a nationwide Integrated Health Information System (IHIS) to streamline patient data management, improve decision-making, and enhance healthcare delivery. The system will integrate hospitals, clinics, and health posts, and include modules for patient records, diagnostics, billing, and public health reporting. The project is backed by donor funding and involves several stakeholders including the Ministry, local hospitals, software vendors, and ICT consultants. A recent assessment of the Ministry's IT environment revealed that many of its current systems are legacy platforms that are difficult to integrate. There is also concern about staff resistance, especially among older employees, and about data security and privacy.

Required:

i Using the Strategic Alignment Model, analyze how the IHIS project can be aligned with the Ministry's health goals and IT capabilities **(15 marks)**

ii Discuss how a SWOT analysis could help identify internal and external factors that may affect the success of the IHIS project. **(15 marks)**

iii Evaluate the potential tangible and intangible benefits that the IHIS could bring to Zambia's healthcare sector. **(10 marks)**

iv Identify and explain three major risks associated with the IHIS project and propose appropriate mitigation strategies. **(10 marks)**

(Total: 50 marks)

SECTION B: Attempt any TWO (2) questions in this section

Question 2

i Define Strategic Information Systems Planning (SISP) and outline its key phases.

(12 marks)

ii Discuss the importance of aligning IT strategy with business strategy. Support your answer with an example. (5 marks)

iii Explain the role of Michael Porter's Value Chain Model in formulating IS strategy.

(8 marks)

(25 Marks)

Question 3

i What are the key components of an effective IT Strategic Plan? **(15 marks)**

ii Explain how project evaluation techniques such as SWOT, the Risk Matrix, and the Delphi Method assist in managing risks in IS projects. **(10 marks)**

(25 marks)

Question 4

i Discuss the importance of IT Governance in Strategic IT Management and explain the role of frameworks like COBIT. **(15 marks)**

ii Describe how Business Process Reengineering (BPR) supports strategic IS planning. Provide one example where BPR led to a successful IS outcome. **(10 marks)**

(25 marks)

END OF EXAMINATION

